

QA LEADERSHIP ACADEMY

Module 2 Assignment — Assessing QA Maturity & Capability

Assignment brief: scenario, deliverables, steps and how your work is assessed.

About this assignment

Northstar's CTO wants "faster, safer releases" but has not defined either. Before you can propose anything, Priya asks for an honest, evidence-based picture of where QA actually stands: a centralised team pulled in late, a five-day manual regression, patchy API coverage, an unstable shared staging environment and metrics that count test cases rather than escaped defects. Your job is to turn that anecdotal picture into a defensible assessment.

What you'll demonstrate

- Assess QA maturity across process, automation, environments, requirements and metrics
- Distinguish evidence from opinion when scoring capability
- Locate the highest-leverage gaps rather than listing every weakness
- Produce a baseline you can measure future progress against

What to submit

- A QA Current-State Assessment for Northstar (using the template)
- A completed QA Maturity Assessment with justified scores
- A QA Capability Heatmap highlighting the two or three areas that most constrain safe, fast delivery

Step-by-step

1. Score Northstar against the QA Maturity Assessment dimensions, citing observable evidence for each level
2. Build the Capability Heatmap so strengths and weak spots are visible at a glance
3. Identify the gaps with the greatest impact on production defects and release confidence
4. Write up the current state using the assessment template, separating what you know from what you still need to confirm
5. Summarise the two or three interventions that would move maturity most, without yet committing to a full plan

Submission format

Submit as a PDF or DOCX combining the written assessment and the heatmap.

How your work is assessed

If a QA lead reviewed this, they would look for:

- Scores backed by concrete Northstar evidence, not gut feel
- A heatmap that a non-QA executive could read and act on
- Prioritisation of the gaps that matter most, not an exhaustive fault list
- A defensible baseline that could be re-measured in six months
- A balanced view that credits genuine strengths alongside weaknesses

Templates & resources to use

- QA Maturity Assessment — find it in the Resource Vault.
- QA Capability Heatmap — find it in the Resource Vault.
- QA Current-State Assessment Template — find it in the Resource Vault.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Maturity scores are only useful if you would defend them in the room. For every rating, be ready to point at the evidence — a heatmap you cannot justify is worse than no heatmap at all.